

MEDINA MASONIC TEMPLE AND MEDINA THEATER
(Medina Masonic Lodge)
120 North Elmwood Avenue
Medina
Medina County
Ohio

HABS OH-30
HABS OH-30

WRITTEN HISTORICAL AND DESCRIPTIVE DATA

REDUCED COPIES OF MEASURED DRAWINGS

FIELD RECORDS

HISTORIC AMERICAN BUILDINGS SURVEY
National Park Service
U.S. Department of the Interior
1849 C Street NW
Washington, DC 20240-0001

HISTORIC AMERICAN BUILDINGS SURVEY
MEDINA MASONIC TEMPLE AND MEDINA THEATER

(Medina Masonic Lodge)

HABS No. OH-30

Location: 120 North Elmwood Avenue, Medina, Medina County, Ohio

The coordinates for the Medina Masonic Temple are 41.139833, -81.865589. These coordinates were obtained in March 2012 from Google Earth (WGS84). There is no restriction on the release of the locational data to the public.

Significance: The Medina Masonic Temple has been a cornerstone of town activity since 1924 as well as serving as a meeting place for the Fraternal Order of Free Masons Lodge No. 58.

Description: The Neoclassical Medina Masonic Temple was built by freemasons in 1924 from brick and sandstone. Much of the exterior decoration was constructed from art stone as a substitute material and is currently in need of repair. Additions to the original structure include an elevator and a connecting entrance between an adjacent walkway and the large theater space. The front entrance has been converted into small office spaces, and the original ballroom converted into a theater, and then theater and dance club. The Masonic lodge room is located on the third floor of the building with a large central meeting room and a mezzanine above.

History: The Medina Masonic Temple was built in 1924 with plans prepared by Ridley and Glazier Architects in Akron, Ohio. The ballroom/theater annex which was added later was designed by architect George Howard Burrows from Aurora, Ohio. In 1996 an elevator was added to the structure and plans were completed by Jerome E. Romis and Associated Architects from Medina, Ohio. This structure has served as a meeting place for a variety of Free Mason organizations including the Blue Lodge, Eastern Star, and Rainbow Brigade. The large ballroom originally was a place for citizens of Medina to gather and socialize when community dances were a common social activity. The ballroom was converted into a theater in the late 1937 as the popularity of movies was growing throughout the country. In 1972 the single, large theater was divided into two separate theaters. Recently, one of the theaters has been converted into a teen dance club for the youth population in Medina. Despite the changes to the ballroom area the temple room has consistently served as a meeting space for Lodge No. 58. The Medina Masonic Temple was added to the National Register of Historic Places in 2002.

Project Information: The documentation of the Medina Masonic Temple was completed for the 2011 Charles E. Peterson Prize Competition by students from Kent State University's College of Architecture and Environmental Design – specifically Professor Elizabeth Murphy's Exploring Historic Structures course. The class team consisted of graduate architecture students, third year architecture students, and interior design students. The versatile team was able to put together a cohesive set of documents for the competition through multiple site visits and field measurements and class pin ups.

The building is used for Lodge functions but is underutilized and is for sale.